

Description

To discover an **unexploded World War 2 (WW2) bomb** in your workplace truly is an **UNEXPECTED EVENT**.

Our team at the CVV North Embankment recently had that experience during earthworks. The UXO was in spoil that had previously been handled and stockpiled in the area, but was previously undiscovered. The UXO was seen exposed on the surface, and the vigilance of the excavator operator and the local team to SLAM and escalate meant that the correct response was made.

Consequences

On this occasion, the CVV team were perfectly prepared and managed the situation perfectly. All works were stopped, the area evacuated, and an exclusion zone set up. The Police were alerted and they contacted Armed Forces specialists and a controlled explosion was safely carried out.

On this occasion, the alertness and prompt actions of the CVV team when dealing with the unexpected meant that no-one was injured.

Causes of Incident

Specialist surveys carried out early in the design and enabling works stage told us that the risk of UXO in the area was very low however, the risk can never be ignored, especially around London which was heavily bombed during WW2.

Photos



ALIGN Actions

RISK AWARENESS

- Safe excavation practices when breaking fresh ground must be controlled with a permit and a survey using cable avoidance equipment which can pick up metal objects that can be exposed under permit conditions.
- Existing or known services and utilities should be identified and physically marked so everyone is aware
- All personnel are reminded to always **consider the unexpected** and to remain vigilant and focussed on uncharted ground obstructions and buried objects.
- Anything unknown or suspicious should lead to a **Stop, Look, Assess, Manage (SLAM)** and the situation should be escalated so it can be properly managed.
- Any suspicious or unexpected metallic objects must be treated with caution. Works should be stopped ("SLAMMED") rather than put people at risk with hand tools, and the area should be evacuated. The situation should be raised with the local site supervision and management.
- Remain focussed on risks and the unexpected around your work activities. It is better to stop work to allow assessment and correct management of **unexpected events**. The **SLAM** process can protect everyone from harm.